

Minutes of the meeting dated 14.09.2026 at 02.30 pm for discussion on the Action Plan for un-interrupted power supply to consumers during the ensuing Durga Puja Festive days of 2026 held at the Seminar Hall, 7th Floor, Vidyut Bhavan.

The Hon'ble Minister-of-State, Power Department, GoWB, presided over the meeting. List of the participants in the meeting is enclosed as **Annexure-A (08 sheets)**.

To begin with, Hon'ble Minister-of-State, Power conveyed thanks to all stakeholders for attending this important meeting from Power utilities & allied organizations with the objective to maintain safe & smooth power supply system throughout the State during Puja festival.

She stated that power requirement at Puja Mandaps during puja festival of this year is likely to be higher than previous year due to announcement of free electricity at Puja mandaps by HCM. She also stated that emphasis should be given on preparedness to ensure seamless and uninterrupted power supply during Puja festivals considering higher load demand.

Principal Secretary, Power Dept, GoWB mentioned that with close coordination with all stakeholders, the State would be able to meet up the total power requirement during the Puja festival, 2026 like previous years.

SLDC thereafter made a presentation on "**West Bengal Power Management during Durgapuja 2026**" considering the forecast data, received from Power Utilities in the State during Puja days i.e. Tithiya to Dashami (14.10.2026 to 21.10.2026), excluding areas served by DVC.

Main discussions:

A. Expected Peak Demand & Power meet up plan:

SLDC estimated total peak demand of the state may reach 11,570 MW on the day of Tithiya (14.10.2026) which will be met by internal and standby sources.

Peak power demand in WBSEDCL, CESC and IPCL areas during Durga Puja days may be around 9445 MW, 2050 MW & 76 MW respectively. Aggregated peak demand is expected to occur on Tithiya (Wednesday).

To manage such peak demand, sufficient Internal Generation, Central & Outside IPP Generation will be available.

To meet the demand, the peak availability scenario was presented with due confirmation from respective utilities.



450 MW of PPSP Generation will be kept under hot spinning reserve for WBSEDCL.

B. System preparedness:

1. WBPDCCL :

CMD, WBPDCCL assured that all Units will be available to provide 100% supply i.e. 4125 MW during Puja festival, if necessary with marginally over & above the existing rated capacity.

He stated that there is no issue regarding availability of Coal stock position in this year due to smooth coordination with the concerned authorities of Railway & CIL. However, necessary support from Railway & CIL authorities are expected to be continued, specially Puja festival.

2. WBSEDCL:

CMD, WBSEDCL mentioned that like every year, all necessary supportive measures, with timely completion of ongoing Pre-puja maintenance works, will be taken up to maintain smooth power supply during Puja like every year. He stated that nearly 3500 mobile maintenance vans will be deployed across the entire state on a 24 x 7 day-night basis along with adequate staff and officers engaged in providing service during Puja festival. Apart from the site offices, round the clock Control room at the DHQ level will be in operation on and from 14.10.2026. 02 nos. dedicated phone numbers (8900793503 & 8900793504) at DHQ are already notified to register grievances regarding services of WBSEDCL during Puja festival.

3. CESC Ltd.:

MD(Gen) assured that their equipment & Units will be available at full capacity during the Puja days. He requested for allotment of 06 coal rakes per day for their power plants for generation of power smoothly during puja festival.

The Principal Secretary, Power requested railway authorities to make adequate arrangements of coal rakes for the same.

In distribution part, following actions / information have been confirmed by ED(Dist.), CESC Ltd.:

- i) Network maintenance has already been started and will be completed much before Mahalaya.
- ii) Like previous years, this year also digital platform facilities will be there to avail connections.
- iii) 50 nos. Nodal Officers and 200 nos. quick response team will be made ready during Puja festival for Puja Pandel survey and prompt attending call dockets towards early restoration.
- iv) 02 nos. dedicated phone numbers (9831079666, 9831083700) are already notified to register grievances regarding services of CESC during Puja festival.
- v) To prevent cable fault, Road excavation work to be restricted with immediate effect.

4. **ERPC:**

Member Secretary, ERPC mentioned that Coal reserves must be monitored and it needs to be maintained well before Puja.

5. **ERLDC:**

Representative of ERLDC (Grid India), assured their full co-operation and support as usual to maintain steady power system during Puja days.

6. **NTPC:**

GM, Farakka of NTPC stated that 325 MW power has been allocated from FSTPS 1 to Punjab till 30.09.2026. Allocation of this power to West Bengal may be helpful to meet up the demand during Puja festival, if it is approved by MoP, Gol.

Principal Secretary, Power, GoWB stated that the matter will be taken up with Ministry of Power, Gol at the earliest.

GM (O&M) of NTPC, Farakka also stated that there is no plant outage / overhauling program before Puja festival and assured that 639 MW power from Farakka will be available during Puja but their present coal stock is critical, with only about 6.1 days of stock remaining.

He also stated that discussions are going with Coal India / Railway authorities and expected that situation will improve before Puja festival.



The Principal Secretary, Power, GoWB requested to Coal India Ltd. / Railway authorities to look into for availability of sufficient coal well in time.

7. **Coal India Limited:**

Representative of Coal India Ltd. assured that they will maintain close coordination with all Generators to ensure smooth supply of Coal as required.

8. **Railway:**

Eastern Railway authority stated that in order to avoid any kind of glitch regarding generation of power during Puja festival, close coordination is required with the Coal authority & Railway authority of all India level. Demand for rakes should be raised early. As coal stock at Farakka unit is critical stage, coordination with sub group (i.e. Ministry of Railway & Coal) by NTPC is required to avoid any kind of coal shortage during Puja festival.

9. **IPCL:**

VP, IPCL stated that their Distribution network are is in order. They are well prepared to cater their projected load demand during Puja. Pre-Puja maintenance work has been started and will be completed well before Puja. They assured to inform about their generation program shortly.

10. **DVC:**

It was noted that no representative of DVC was present. Principal Secretary, Power Dept., GoWB informed that every year, DVC confirms that around 300 MW will be available to WBSEDCL in case of exigency. DVC may be requested accordingly by Director (RT), WBSEDCL.

11. **DPL:**

MD, DPL stated that they are well prepared to cater their projected load demand during Puja at 500 MW level.

12. **WBSETCL:**

Director (Operation), WBSETCL apprised that Pre-Puja maintenance works i.r.o. Grid Sub-stations and lines has started and will be completed shortly i.e. well before Mahalaya. There would not be any transmission congestion during Pujas.

13. **NHPC:**

NHPC officials stated that their generation will be around 135 MW during Puja festival.

14. **Power Grid:**

CGM, Power Grid informed that commissioning of 6th PTR of 500 MVA at Subhasgram GSS since last Puja has enhanced redundancy for state capital. He also mentioned that they are fully ready for smooth Power supply during Puja days.

Principal Secretary, Power, GoWB advised CESC & WBSEDCL authorities to conduct Pandnel inspection proactively to check the condition of the wires / cables which are being used by the agencies, engaged by the Puja Committee, from safety point of view. No improper joint / insulated wire leakage (due to damage insulation) will be allowed to prevent any accidental hazard.

After deliberation / interactions with the representative of each of the present utilities & allied Organizations, Principal Secretary, Power, GoWB requested Hon'ble Minister-of-State, Power, to give her valued comments and suggestions before the attending Officers.

Reminding the status and importance of Durga Puja in Bengal, Hon'ble Minister-of-State, Power, requested representatives from all Utilities to maintain close liaison / coordination with each other so that 24 x 7 uninterrupted power supply can be maintained throughout during Puja days and wished all present for the upcoming festival. The meeting concluded with thanks given to the Chair.



(Gargi Das Ghosh)
Minister-of-State
Power Deptt. GoWB